



“Entrepreneurial Motivation” by Chamara D. Jayaweera

Agenda

- Introduction
- Entrepreneurial Journey
- Entrepreneurial Motivators
- Tips for aspiring entrepreneurs
- Q & A



1. INTRODUCTION (1/3) : ABOUT ME



- Graduated in **Computer Science** from University of Colombo School of Computing (UCSC) in 2008
- **MBA (UK)** from London Metropolitan University in 2022
- **Executive MBA** at Post Graduate Institute of Management (PIM), University of Sri Jayewardenepura
- **16+ years** of industry experience in multiple domains
- Currently the Co-Founder and **Managing Director of Itechro**

• PROFESSIONAL QUALIFICATIONS

- Project Management Institute (PMI)
 - - Project Management Professional (**PMP**)
 - - PMI Agile Certified Practitioner (**PMI-ACP**)
- Scrum Alliance
 - - Certified Scrum Master (**CSM**)
 - - Certified Scrum Product Owner (**CSPO**)
- Axelos
 - - **ITIL V4** Foundation Certified
- Amazon Web Services (AWS)
 - - **AWS Certified** Solutions Architect - Associate
- Sun Microsystems
 - - Sun Certified Business Component Developer (**SCBCD**)
 - - Sun Certified Web Component Developer (**SCWCD**)
 - - Sun Certified Mobile Application Developer (**SCMAD**)
 - - Sun Certified Java Programmer (**SCJP**)



1. INTRODUCTION (2/3) : JOURNEY - FROM A STUDENT TO AN ENTREPRENEUR

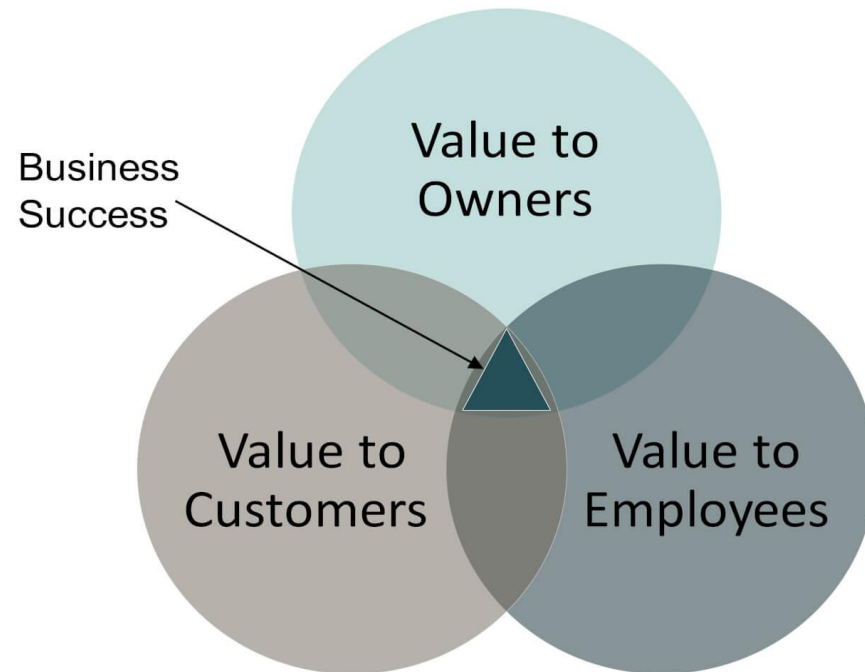
- 2003: A/Ls – Maths Stream 3 Bs, 2004: A/Ls 2A 1C
- 2005 – 2008: Computer Science Undergraduate at University of Colombo School of Computing
- **Feb 2008 – Aug 2008: Internship in Software Development**
- **Aug 2008 – Nov 2010: Software Engineer at IronOne**
- **Dec 2010 – Apr 2013: Senior Software Engineer at John Keells / ISA**
- **May 2013 – Apr 2018: Tech Lead/Senior Tech Lead at Proavos / Avtra**
- **Apr 2018: Co-Founding Itechro**
- **Jan 2023: Incooperating Itechro Australia**
- Now the Managing Director at Itechro

1. INTRODUCTION (3/3) : OVERVIEW OF ENTREPRENEURSHIP

There are many academic definitions, but in my experience:

“How we can create continuous value by exploring the opportunities to produce innovative outcome for the society”

Value Creation for Business Success



Technical Skills

+

Entrepreneurial Mindset

= ????

From where are we getting
“Entrepreneurial Mindset”?

2. ENTREPRENEURIAL JOURNEY (1/2): PERSONAL ENTREPRENEURIAL EXPERIENCE

Challenges in the beginning

1. How to start “something”?
2. How to find money?
3. How to find investors?
4. How to find customers?
5. How to build a team?
6. How to make an innovation?
7. How to convince the people?
8. How to communicate?

Challenges after the beginning

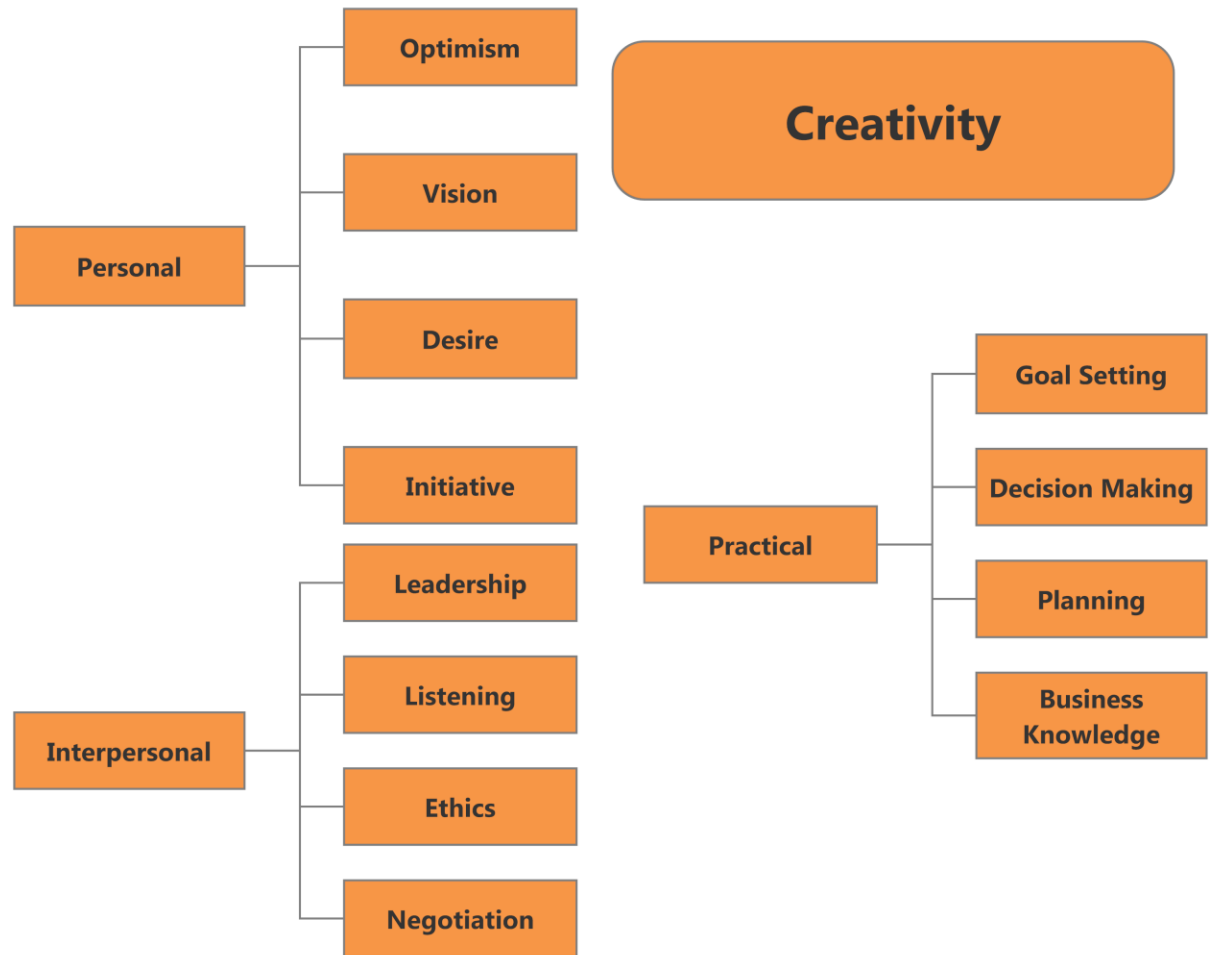
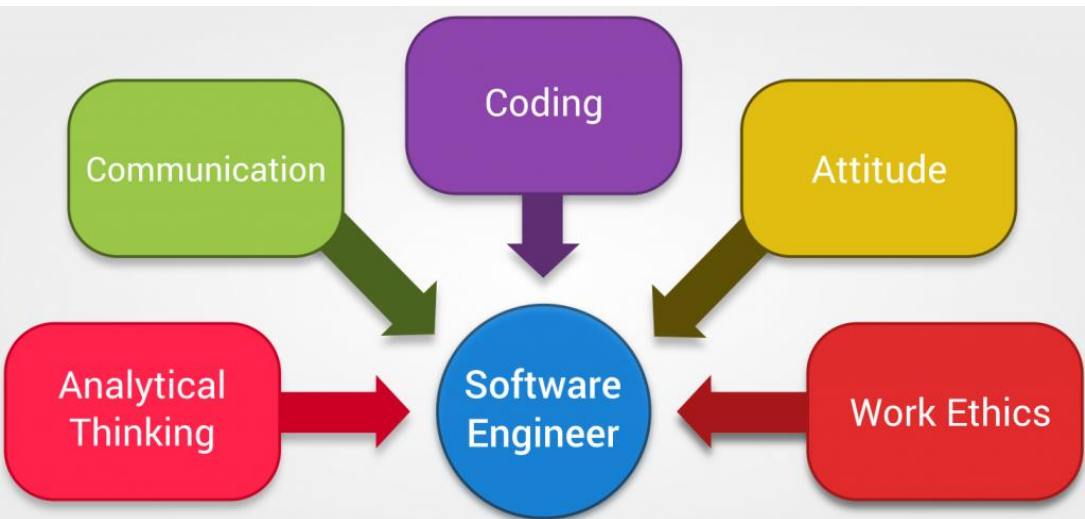
1. How to expand?
2. How to maintain the cashflow?
3. How to maintain finance?
4. How to look after the HR?
5. How to look after the well being?
6. How to manage the time?
7. “How to Survive?”

Unforeseen Challenges

1. Covid Outbreak
2. Economic Crisis and Inflation
3. Skill employees turnover
4. Power Cuts

***** It's all about Risk, Learning and Adaptability *****

2. ENTREPRENEURIAL JOURNEY (2/2) TRANSITION FROM EMPLOYEE TO ENTREPRENEUR



3. KEY ENTREPRENEURIAL MOTIVATORS

- **Passion**
 - Passionate about work, passionate about technology, passionate to solve problems
- **Vision**
 - Purpose and direction
- **Commitment**
 - Once you are committed, "That's It"
- **Hard work**
 - Commitment only does not work till you put the hard work to achieve what you committed
- **Resillience**
 - How fast you can get back???
- **Patience**
 - How long you need to wait???
- **Empathy + Sense of Humor**

4. TIPS FOR ASPIRING ENTREPRENEURS

- **Learn with passion for the rest of the academic period**
- **Do a good final year project with an intention of going for a good internship**
- **Build up your soft skills with better communication**
- **Find your first job with a place you would enjoy, not only because of having a big name**
- **Don't do just the "job" assigned to you, add the "value" to what you add to your work place**
- **Be a good team player, not just an individual performer**
- **Try to grab a holistic experience by contributing to the whole SDLC**
- **Never give up on your learning**
- **Build your network, "Your network is your net worth"**
- **Build your own personal brand from "now"**
- **There is nothing called "Work-Life Balance", It is all about "Work-Family-Society Harmony"**



Thank you

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